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ENGLISH

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The Solitary Reaper - William Wordsworth

A Note The Poet :

William Wordsworth (1770-1850) was the Poet Laureate of the United Kingdom, and remains an important figure in English literature. Lyrical Ballads (1798), a book of poems that he co-authored with S.T. Coleridge, helped launch the Romantic Age in English literature. Wordsworth laid stress on the importance of nature and the simple life, and felt that poetry should be written in the language of ordinary people. Some of his major works are The Prelude, 'Lines Composed a Few Miles above Tintern Abbey', 'Daffodils' and 'The World is Too Much With Us'.

The Solitary Reaper Summary :

Introduction :

The Solitary Reaper is a romantic poem that captures a moment of natural beauty and emotional depth. It was inspired by Wordsworth's trip to Scotland. The poem shows how a simple scene a girl singing in a field can leave a powerful, lasting impact on a sensitive mind.

First Stanza:

Behold her, single in the field,
Yon solitary Highland Lass!
Reaping and singing by herself;
Stop here, or gently pass!
Alone she cuts and binds the grain,
And sings a melancholy strain;
O listen! for the Vale profound
Is overflowing with the sound.

The poet asks the reader to look at a young Highland girl working alone in a field. She is harvesting the crops and singing a sad song as she works. The poet tells passers-by to either stop and listen quietly or move gently without disturbing her. The girl's song is so powerful and sweet that it fills the entire valley with her melody.

Second Stanza:

**No Nightingale did ever chaunt
More welcome notes to weary bands
Of travellers in some shady haunt,
Among Arabian sands:
A voice so thrilling ne'er was heard
In spring-time from the Cuckoo-bird,
Breaking the silence of the seas
Among the farthest Hebrides.**

The poet compares the girl's voice to the sweetest sounds in nature. He says that even the nightingale, whose song is a comfort to tired travelers resting in the Arabian desert, is not as welcome as the reaper's song. He also mentions the cuckoo bird, whose voice in the distant Hebrides islands signals the arrival of spring, but says that even the cuckoo's song is less thrilling than the girl's.

Third Stanza:

**Will no one tell me what she sings?
Perhaps the plaintive numbers flow
For old, unhappy, far-off things,
And battles long ago:
Or is it some more humble lay,
Familiar matter of today?
Some natural sorrow, loss, or pain,
That has been, and may be again?**

The poet wonders what the girl's song is about. Since he cannot understand the language, he imagines that it might be a sad song about historical events, like old battles and faraway sorrows. Or it could be about simple, everyday sadness about sorrow, loss, or pain that is common in human life and repeats itself through time.

Fourth Stanza:

**Whate'er the theme, the Maiden sang
As if her song could have no ending;
I saw her singing at her work,
And o'er the sickle bending;**

**I listened, motionless and still;
And, as I mounted up the hill,
The music in my heart I bore,
Long after it was heard no more.**

The poet says that no matter what the theme of the song was, the girl's singing left a deep impression on him. She sang so beautifully that it seemed endless. The poet stood still, completely absorbed in the music. Even after he left the field and could no longer hear her, the memory of her song stayed with him, filling his heart and becoming a part of him forever.

Main Themes In the Poem :

1.Beauty in Simplicity: The simple act of singing while working becomes something beautiful and unforgettable.

2.Power of Music: Music can touch emotions deeply, even if the words are not understood.

3.Nature and Human Connection: Nature and human emotions are deeply intertwined in Romantic poetry.

4.Memory and Imagination: Sometimes, experiences are more powerful in memory than in reality.

Conclusion:

Wordsworth's The Solitary Reaper reminds us that even ordinary moments, if truly felt, can become extraordinary. It shows how beauty, even in the simplest forms, can leave a permanent mark on the human soul.

I. Short Answer Questions.

1. Who was the solitary reaper?

Ans: The solitary reaper was a young Highland girl who was working alone in a field, harvesting crops while singing a sorrowful song.

2. Identify the word that best describes the reaper's song.

Ans: The word that best describes the reaper's song is "melancholy," meaning sad and touching.

3. The poet compares the reaper's song to which two birds?

Ans: The poet compares the reaper's song to the song of the nightingale and the cuckoo-bird.

4. What was the singer doing while singing?

- a. sitting alone in a field
- b. cutting grass
- c. harvesting crops
- d. weaving baskets

Ans: (c) harvesting crops

5. Which of the following is true?

- a. The poet stopped to listen to the song for a while, before resuming his walk.
- b. The poet listened till the end of the song, before resuming his walk.
- c. The poet slowed down and listened to the song as he continued walking.
- d. None of the above

Ans: (a) The poet stopped to listen to the song for a while, before resuming his walk.

6. The poet describes the vale as with the reaper's song.

Ans: The poet describes the vale as overflowing with the reaper's song.

II. Answer the following questions in about one pages each.

1. Narrate how the poet spots the solitary reaper. What is his impression of the reaper?

Ans: The poet, William Wordsworth, while walking through the Scottish Highlands, spots a young girl working alone in a field. She is harvesting crops and singing a sad song. Her loneliness and dedication catch the poet's attention immediately. He is deeply moved by the beauty of her voice and the sorrowful tone of her song. Wordsworth feels

that her music is so powerful that it fills the entire valley. He is so enchanted that he urges others either to stop and listen or to pass by quietly so as not to disturb her. The sight and sound leave a lasting impression on him.

2. Describe the solitary reaper and her surroundings.

Ans: The solitary reaper is a young Highland girl working alone in a field, reaping and binding the crops. She sings a melancholic song as she works. The surroundings are peaceful and beautiful an open field in the Scottish Highlands with a deep valley (vale) around. The atmosphere is filled with the sound of her voice, making the valley seem alive. There is no one else with her, and her song echoes through the hills, creating a mood of serene sadness and deep emotional beauty.

3. What do you think the poet's thoughts would be when he remembers the song years later?

Ans: When the poet remembers the song years later, he would likely feel a sense of peace and wonder. The beauty and sadness of the solitary reaper's song would stay fresh in his heart, offering him comfort and joy even in distant memories. The music, though no longer physically heard, would continue to inspire and soothe him. It would remind him of the deep emotions tied to simple, everyday moments and the everlasting power of art and nature.

4. Comment on the following lines with reference to the poem:

a. "Some natural sorrow, loss, or pain, / That has been, and may be again!"

Ans: These lines show the poet's guess about the theme of the reaper's song. Since he cannot understand the language, he imagines that she might be singing about universal human emotions such as sorrow, loss, or pain feelings that occur naturally in everyone's life and repeat through time. It suggests that her song reflects deep human experiences that are timeless.

b. "The music in my heart I bore, / Long after it was heard no more."

Ans: These lines express how deeply the reaper's song affected the poet. Even after he could no longer physically hear the song, its memory stayed alive in his heart. The song became a permanent source of joy and inspiration for him, showing the lasting impact of beautiful experiences on the human soul.

c. "Stop here, or gently pass!"

Ans: In this line, the poet addresses passers-by, telling them either to stop and listen quietly to the girl's beautiful singing or to move away softly without disturbing her. It

shows the poet's deep respect for the purity of the moment and his desire to protect the beauty and solitude of the reaper's singing.

5. What, according to the poet, was the reaper's song about?

Ans: According to the poet, the reaper's song could have been about old, sad events, battles fought long ago, or it might have been about more ordinary sorrows and pains of daily life. Even though he could not understand the exact words, he felt that the song conveyed deep emotions of sadness, loss, and longing that touched him deeply.

III. Answer the following questions in about two pages each.

1. How is the song of the reaper described by the poet?

Ans: The poet, William Wordsworth, describes the song of the reaper in vivid, emotionally charged terms. From the very beginning of the poem, the reaper's song is portrayed as enchanting and deeply moving. The poet compares the song to the sounds of nature to the nightingale and cuckoo-bird saying that even the most beautiful bird songs do not match the depth and emotion of the reaper's melody.

The song is referred to as "melancholy," indicating that it has a sad or sorrowful tone. Wordsworth immediately recognizes the emotional power of the song, despite not understanding the language in which it is sung. He imagines that the song could be about "old, unhappy, far-off things" or perhaps "battles long ago," suggesting that it conveys themes of sadness and loss. The song is both timeless and universal, as the poet feels that it could be about sorrow and pain that anyone could relate to, across time and place.

Wordsworth describes the effect the song has on the valley, noting that it "overflows" the vale. This gives the impression that the music fills the entire landscape, creating a profound connection between the girl's song and the natural surroundings. The poet even says that the reaper's voice is "thrilling," a quality that makes the song unforgettable. He imagines that her song could go on forever, reflecting both its beauty and its emotional weight.

By comparing the reaper's song to the songs of birds, Wordsworth highlights its natural beauty and emotional intensity. The song, though simple, is powerful enough to stir deep feelings and stir the imagination.

2. Discuss the impact of the reaper's song on the poet's thoughts and feelings.

Ans: The reaper's song has a profound impact on the poet's thoughts and emotions. Initially, Wordsworth is struck by the beauty and melancholy of the song. The song's deep emotional tone touches him in a way that no other sound has. He is enchanted by its sweetness, but it is the emotional resonance that lingers with him long after he has moved on.

While he listens to the song, the poet experiences a powerful connection to the reaper. Even though he cannot understand the language, he senses the sorrow, loss, or pain conveyed in the music. His imagination begins to roam as he tries to interpret the meaning of the song. He considers that it could be about ancient battles or distant sorrow. He wonders whether it reflects a personal pain that the reaper feels, or if it is just the kind of sorrow that everyone experiences at some point in their lives.

The impact of the song on the poet is long-lasting. As the poet walks away from the scene and continues his journey, the song stays with him. In fact, the memory of the song "remains in his heart" and continues to "live on" in his thoughts. Even when the physical sound is no longer there, the emotional resonance of the song is carried in his heart. The poet's feelings about the song reflect the Romantic belief that beauty, art, and nature can deeply affect the human spirit. This impact is enduring and far-reaching. He is deeply moved by the experience and carries its memory with him as something that shapes his view of life and beauty.

The poet's thoughts reflect a sense of awe at the power of the song. He sees it as a reminder of the emotional depth that simple, everyday moments can carry. The reaper's song is not just a beautiful melody; it is a representation of human emotions that transcend time and place. It highlights the poet's sensitivity to nature and his belief in the importance of art as a force for emotional connection.

3. The beauty of the countryside is an important aspect of this poem. How is this beauty captured in the poem?

Ans: The beauty of the countryside is a central theme in *The Solitary Reaper*, and it is captured by Wordsworth through vivid descriptions of the landscape, the atmosphere, and the reaper's song. The countryside is not just a backdrop for the poem but an integral part of the experience that the poet describes. It contributes to the emotional depth of the scene and adds to the profound connection between the natural world and human feelings.

The poet first introduces the countryside by describing the "solitary" reaper in the "field." The use of the word "solitary" emphasizes the peaceful and quiet nature of the rural setting. The reaper works alone, yet her song fills the entire "vale" (valley), giving the

countryside an almost magical quality. The song is so powerful that it seems to resonate through the entire valley, filling the air with music. The valley becomes a symbol of the emotional richness of the natural world, where even solitude can evoke deep feelings of connection and beauty.

Wordsworth contrasts the countryside with the busy, noisy world. He describes the “Arabian sands” and “the seas” as distant settings where the voices of nightingales and cuckoos are traditionally heard. By doing so, he elevates the rural setting in the poem, suggesting that the reaper’s song is even more moving and beautiful than the sounds heard in far-off, exotic locations.

The poet also emphasizes the peacefulness of the countryside. The reaper sings alone, creating an image of tranquil, undisturbed nature. This solitude adds a sense of purity to the scene, as the reaper is depicted as connected to nature through her work and song. The countryside becomes a place where the natural world and human emotions are deeply intertwined.

The beauty of the countryside is also conveyed through the imagery of the poet’s memory. As he moves away from the reaper, the landscape remains in his mind, and the song continues to echo in his heart. This suggests that the emotional beauty of the countryside especially through the reaper’s song is something that stays with the poet, much like the natural world’s ability to leave a lasting impression on a sensitive soul.

In conclusion, Wordsworth captures the beauty of the countryside not just through its physical descriptions, but through its emotional resonance. The landscape is not merely a setting; it is a living part of the poem that enhances the emotional impact of the reaper’s song. The rural setting, with its peace and solitude, becomes a symbol of the deeper connections between nature and human experience.

The Lotus - Toru Dutt

A Note On The Poet :

Toru Dutt (1856-77) was born into a well-known family in Rambagan, Kolkata. Her family converted to Christianity in 1862, and they remained devout Christians throughout their lives. However, she never lost touch with Hinduism and was much inspired by Hindu mythology and legends, and this is reflected in her works. She was the first Indian woman poet to write in English, and is often referred to as the 'Keats of Indo-English Literature'. She wrote in both English and French and left behind an impressive legacy of poetry and prose when she died at the young age of twenty-one.

The Lotus Summary :

Introduction :

The poem "The Lotus" is a short allegorical (symbolic) poem where Toru Dutt presents a rivalry between two famous flowers the rose and the lily. The poet uses this flower rivalry to show how the lotus, an important flower in Indian culture, is the perfect combination of beauty and purity.

First Stanza

**"Love came to Flora asking for a flower
That would of flowers be undisputed queen,
The lily and the rose, long, long had been
Rivals for that high honour."**

The poem opens with Love (the god of love) visiting Flora (goddess of flowers). Love wants Flora to create a new flower that would be accepted as the undisputed queen of all flowers. Until now, the lily and the rose had been competing (rivals) for this title, with no clear winner. Both flowers are famous the rose for its beauty and the lily for its grace but the competition between them remains unresolved.

Second Stanza

**"Bards of power
Had sung their claims. The rose can never tower
Like the pale lily with her Juno mien
'But is the lily lovelier?' Thus between
Flower-factions rang the strife in Flora's bower."**

Here, Toru Dutt says that great poets (bards) have supported both the rose and the lily in their poetry. Some say the rose is beautiful, but it can never stand tall and proud like the lily, who looks majestic, just like Juno (queen of the Roman gods). However, others question if the lily is truly more beautiful than the rose. Because of these divided opinions, a constant quarrel or strife happens in Flora's bower (garden).

Third Stanza

**"'Give me a flower delicious as the rose
And stately as the lily in her pride.'
'But of what colour?' 'Rose-red,' Love first chose,
Then prayed, 'No, lily-white, or, both provide.'"**

To settle the issue, Love asks Flora to create a flower that is as charming and sweet as the rose, and as dignified and grand as the lily. Flora asks him what colour the new flower should be.

First, Love chooses rose-red for beauty, but then he changes his mind and says lily-white would also be nice or better, a combination of both colours.

Fourth Stanza

**"And Flora gave the lotus, 'rose-red' dyed,
And 'lily-white,' the queenliest flower that blows."**

Flora fulfills Love's wish by creating the lotus. The lotus has the rose-red colour for beauty and the lily-white for purity, making it the perfect flower.

Thus, the lotus becomes the queenliest flower the most majestic and superior among all flowers.

Themes In the Poem :

1. Harmony and Balance : The lotus combines the best qualities of both the rose (beauty) and the lily (purity), symbolizing how harmony is better than rivalry.

2. Ideal Beauty : True beauty is shown as a balance between charm and dignity — a combination of outward attractiveness and inner purity.

3. Resolution of Conflict : Instead of siding with one flower, Flora creates a new one, ending the dispute. The theme shows that creation and compromise are better than fighting.

4. National Pride : By choosing the lotus, a sacred flower in Indian tradition, Toru Dutt expresses pride in Indian culture and its rich heritage.

5. Mythology and Nature : The poem draws heavily from Greek and Roman mythology (Love, Flora, Juno) and shows nature as alive, full of emotions and competitions.

I. Short Answer Questions.

1. What does Love ask Flora, the goddess of flowers?

Ans: Love asks Flora to create a flower that would be the undisputed queen among all flowers, combining the best qualities of the rose and the lily.

2. Where did the 'flower factions ring strife'?

Ans: The 'flower factions' rang strife in Flora's bower, which means the arguments and rivalry between supporters of the rose and lily took place in the garden of Flora.

3. How does the flower goddess solve the 'strife'?

Ans: Flora solves the strife by creating the lotus, a flower that combines the beauty of the rose and the dignity of the lily, ending the rivalry between the two flowers.

4. Which of the following qualities is ascribed to the rose?

- a. being delicious
- b. being fragrant
- c. being stately
- d. being flighty

Ans: (a) being delicious

5. Which of the following words is not used to describe the lily?

- a. stately
- b. pride
- c. white
- d. blushing

Ans: (d) blushing

6. The _____ had sung the praises of the rose and the lily for many ages.

Ans: Bards

II. Answer the Following Questions in About One Page Each.

1. Highlight the significance of the colours of the lotus.

Ans: The colours of the lotus rose-red and lily-white have great significance in the poem. The rose-red colour represents beauty, charm, and attraction, qualities traditionally associated with the rose. The lily-white colour stands for purity, dignity, and majesty, which are characteristics linked to the lily. By combining these two colours, the lotus symbolizes the perfect blend of physical beauty and spiritual purity. The two

colours also reflect how true greatness comes from uniting the best traits of different things. Thus, the lotus becomes the ideal flower, surpassing both the rose and the lily.

2. What is meant by the line, 'Like the pale lily with her Juno mien'?

Ans: The line 'Like the pale lily with her Juno mien' compares the lily to the Roman goddess Juno, who is known for her regal and majestic appearance. Here, the lily is described as tall, pale, and noble, just like Juno. The word 'mien' means appearance or manner. So, this line means that the lily has a dignified and proud look, which makes it appear royal and impressive, much like the goddess Juno herself.

3. Why couldn't Love choose between the two flowers?

Ans: Love could not choose between the two flowers because both the rose and the lily had their unique and special qualities. The rose was charming and attractive, while the lily was dignified and pure. Love wanted a flower that had both beauty and stateliness. Since each flower was strong in only one quality, Love found it difficult to pick one over the other. This led to the desire for a new flower that combined the best qualities of both resulting in the creation of the lotus.

4. Explain the line 'Bards of power / Had sung their claims.'

Ans: The line 'Bards of power / Had sung their claims' means that great and influential poets (bards) had praised both the rose and the lily for many years. These poets wrote beautiful verses in favour of both flowers, describing their beauty and greatness. Their poetry added to the rivalry between the rose and the lily, making it difficult to decide which flower deserved to be called the queen.

5. The lotus is referred to as the 'queenliest flower'. Justify.

Ans: The lotus is called the 'queenliest flower' because it successfully combines the best qualities of both the rose and the lily. It has the rose's beauty and delightful charm, and the lily's purity and nobility. Flora, the goddess of flowers, created the lotus at the request of Love to end the rivalry between the rose and the lily. By blending the colours rose-red and lily-white, the lotus achieves perfect balance and harmony. This unique combination makes the lotus superior to all other flowers, deserving the title of the 'queenliest flower.'

III. Answer the Following Questions in About two Pages Each.

1. Recount the circumstances leading to the creation of the lotus flower.

Ans: In Toru Dutt's poem The Lotus, the creation of the lotus flower occurs because of a dispute among flowers in Flora's garden. Love, the god of love, finds himself unable to

choose between the rose and the lily. Both flowers possess admirable but different qualities. The rose is associated with beauty, charm, and sweetness, while the lily stands for dignity, pride, and purity.

The supporters of each flower were engaged in constant quarrels, each claiming superiority for their flower. This conflict created a lot of unrest and strife in Flora's bower (garden). Flora, the goddess of flowers, is approached by Love with a request to create a new flower that would settle the arguments once and for all by combining the best traits of both the rose and the lily.

Flora, listening to Love's appeal, decides to create a flower that would incorporate the rose's vibrant colour and the lily's stately appearance. Thus, she gives birth to the lotus a flower blending rose-red and lily-white hues. The lotus possesses both beauty and majesty, becoming the ultimate queen of flowers. Its creation finally ends the dispute among the flowers, as it unites all the noble qualities that the rose and lily individually represented.

Hence, the lotus emerges from the need to resolve rivalry and establish a perfect, undisputed flower that embodies ideal beauty and dignity, fulfilling Love's wish.

2. Elaborate on the theme of the poem. How does the diction enhance or contribute to the tone?

Ans: The main theme of The Lotus is the harmonious blending of beauty and nobility to create perfection. Toru Dutt suggests that true excellence comes not from individual brilliance but from combining the finest qualities of different things. The poem also explores themes of rivalry, creation, beauty, unity, and idealism.

Another important theme is the resolution of conflict through creation. The rose and the lily symbolize two opposing but admirable traits. Their conflict is only resolved when a new flower, the lotus, is created, highlighting the poet's belief in synthesis rather than division.

The diction (choice of words) significantly enhances the tone of the poem. Words like "delicious," "pride," "pale," "queenliest," and "flower-factions" give a majestic, serious, and formal tone to the poem. The use of mythological references (Love, Flora, Juno) adds a classical and elevated style, matching the importance of the creation being described.

Moreover, Toru Dutt's rich, descriptive language makes the flowers come alive in the reader's mind. Her choice of words gives grandeur to the poem and fits the solemn yet

celebratory mood as the lotus is created. The slightly formal and poetic diction raises the tone from a simple story about flowers to a reflection on perfection and harmony.

Thus, the diction supports the poem's majestic and harmonious tone, aligning beautifully with its deeper themes.

3. How does the poet use colours and Greek mythology to demonstrate the theme of the poem? Use examples from the text to substantiate your answer.

Ans: Toru Dutt cleverly uses colours and Greek mythology to demonstrate her themes of perfection, unity, and the blending of the best qualities in The Lotus.

The colours used in the poem rose-red and lily-white are symbolic. The rose-red colour stands for passion, energy, beauty, and love. The lily-white colour symbolizes purity, dignity, and serenity. By combining these two colours in the lotus, the poet shows how different virtues can be merged to create a perfect and harmonious whole. The lotus, thus, is not merely a new flower but a symbol of ideal unity.

The poet also uses Greek mythology extensively. She refers to Flora, the Roman goddess of flowers, and Love, likely referring to Cupid, the god of love. Another mythological figure mentioned is Juno, the queen of the gods, known for her proud and majestic bearing. When the poet describes the lily as having "Juno mien," she highlights the lily's stateliness and pride.

These mythological references elevate the importance of the flowers and the situation, giving the poem a grand, timeless feeling. They make the conflict among flowers seem like a serious and dignified matter worthy of divine intervention.

Through these classical images and symbolic colours, Toru Dutt illustrates the central theme: that true beauty and greatness come from the union of diverse strengths, and that harmony, rather than rivalry, leads to perfection.

Uncle Podger Hangs a Picture - Jerome K. Jerome

A Note On The Author :

Jerome Klapka Jerome (1859-1927), is an English journalist, playwright and novelist who is best known for his comic travelogue *Three Men in a Boat*. Having lost his father at an early age, Jerome had to give up his studies in order to work and support his family. He pursued various professions such as acting, journalism and teaching without much success. However, he gained popularity with the publication of *Three Men in a Boat* in 1889, which displays his singular narrative expertise. Jerome is remembered for his distinctive humour that is warm, at times silly, even farcical, but hardly ever satirical.

Uncle Podger Hangs a Picture Summary :

Introduction :

"Uncle Podger Hangs a Picture" by Jerome K. Jerome is a humorous story that describes how a simple job can turn into a complete disaster when handled by a clumsy and overconfident person. The story is an excellent example of Jerome's brilliant comic writing, where everyday situations are shown in an exaggerated and funny way.

The story begins with Uncle Podger deciding to hang a picture on the wall. He says proudly, "You leave that to me. Don't you worry yourselves about that." He wants to show that he is capable of doing everything by himself without troubling anyone else. But what happens is just the opposite.

As soon as Uncle Podger starts, he creates chaos. He asks one person to hold the chair for him, another person to get him a nail, someone else to find the hammer, and another to bring a ruler. In no time, the whole house is involved in the task. Everyone is running here and there, trying to find tools for him.

Uncle Podger, meanwhile, manages to lose almost everything the nail, the hammer, even the picture itself. Each time he loses something, he gets angry and shouts at

others, blaming them for his mistakes. He behaves as if he is carrying the whole burden of the work, while actually doing nothing properly.

He injures himself while trying to fix the nail to the wall. He bangs his thumb with the hammer and makes a huge noise about it, as if he's very badly hurt. He demands sympathy from everyone but doesn't stop blaming them for distracting him.

Not only that, but while trying to hold the picture, he drops it. In the process, he breaks a valuable table and scratches the walls. His coat gets torn too. Every small mistake leads to more shouting, scolding, and confusion. The house, which was peaceful before, becomes a place of mess and noise.

After hours of trouble, when everyone is tired and annoyed, Uncle Podger finally manages to hang the picture, though it is crooked and not very perfect. He then stands back, proudly admiring his work, as if he has achieved something very great. He says that if he had hired a professional workman to do the job, it would have cost a lot of money and wouldn't have been done any better.

The humor in the story comes from the fact that Uncle Podger thinks he is very skilled and independent, but in reality, he is clumsy, forgetful, and totally dependent on others. He cannot even hang a picture properly without creating a drama.

Character of Uncle Podger:

He is overconfident but lacks real skill.

He creates confusion wherever he goes.

He blames others for his own carelessness.

He has a habit of making small things seem big.

He believes he is very hardworking and capable, even when the truth is the opposite.

Theme and Message: The story highlights human weaknesses in a funny way. It shows that:

Some people think too highly of themselves without realizing their mistakes.

Overconfidence can turn simple things into complicated disasters.

Blaming others instead of accepting responsibility is a common human flaw.

Everyday life has a lot of humor if we observe it carefully.

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I. Short Answer Questions.

1. What was the commotion all about in Uncle Podger's house?

Ans: The commotion in Uncle Podger's house was due to his attempt to hang a picture on the wall. He turned the simple task into a chaotic event by involving everyone in the house, misplacing tools, losing items, and creating a big fuss, which made the house a place of confusion and noise.

2. Why did Uncle Podger send the girl out?

Ans: Uncle Podger sent the girl out to fetch him a hammer. He believed he needed everything to be done perfectly, so he gave specific instructions to everyone, even sending the girl on tasks like getting tools or items, making her run around the house.

3. How was the 'fine musical effect' on the piano created?

Ans: The 'fine musical effect' on the piano was created when Uncle Podger accidentally knocked over a chair. The chair hit the piano keys, producing random sounds, which he mistakenly believed were part of the process of hanging the picture.

4. Uncle Podger was unable to find his handkerchief because:

- a. it was in the pocket of his pants
- b. the cat had dragged it away
- c. it was in the pocket of a coat he couldn't find

Ans: d. all of the above

5. What problem cropped up after the hammer was found?

- a. he hit his thumb with the hammer
- b. he threw it out of the window
- c. he lost the nail
- d. none of the above

Ans: a. he hit his thumb with the hammer

6. Uncle Podger characterizes Aunt Maria's observations about needing to leave the house when the former decides to take up a project as

Ans: Uncle Podger humorously characterizes Aunt Maria's observations as an overreaction. He implies that Aunt Maria was overly concerned, even suggesting she might want to leave the house because he was about to take on a big task. This is part of his exaggerated sense of his own importance and ability to handle projects.

II. Answer the following questions in about one page each.

1. How does Uncle Podger lose various items in his attempts to hang a picture?

Ans: Uncle Podger loses various items during his attempt to hang a picture due to his clumsiness and lack of organization. First, he sends people out to find tools, but despite his efforts, he ends up misplacing everything. For example, he can't find the nail, hammer, or ladder when he needs them. He blames others for misplacing these items, but it's clear that it's his own carelessness causing the confusion. The search for these items adds to the commotion in the house, and each time he can't find something, he asks others to help look for it. This misplacement of tools and objects continues throughout the story and contributes to the chaos he creates.

2. Analyse the writer's observation that the wall looked as though it had been 'smoothed down with a rake'. How do you visualize the state of the house after Uncle Podger's antics?

Ans: The writer's observation that the wall looked as though it had been "smoothed down with a rake" is a humorous way to describe the disorganized and chaotic state of the room after Uncle Podger's attempt to hang the picture. This metaphor suggests that the wall was covered with marks, scratches, and perhaps even dents from Uncle Podger's numerous failed attempts. It paints a picture of a messy, disheveled room where everything has gone wrong. The house, in general, looks like it has been affected by the disarray caused by Uncle Podger's clumsy actions the furniture is out of place, the walls are damaged, and the family is exhausted. This imagery emphasizes how his efforts, though well-meaning, lead to destruction and chaos instead of a successful outcome.

3. What was Uncle Podger's concluding remark? Why do you think he made it?

Ans: Uncle Podger's concluding remark was that, had he hired a workman to hang the picture, it would have cost a lot of money and wouldn't have been done any better. This statement is ironic and humorous. He says this to justify the chaos he caused, believing his own hard work and effort made up for the mistakes he made along the way. Uncle Podger makes this remark because he wants to appear as though he did a great job despite the mess and the difficulty he caused for everyone. It's a reflection of his overconfidence and his need to assert that he can do things better than anyone else, even when the evidence shows otherwise.

4. Comment on how Uncle Podger deals with the misplacement and discovery of his coat.

Ans: Uncle Podger's handling of the misplacement and discovery of his coat adds to the comic nature of the story. At first, he can't find his coat, which is essential for him to carry out the task of hanging the picture. He becomes frustrated and blames everyone around him for the lost coat. The process of finding the coat involves more running around and searching, which only adds to the confusion in the house. When the coat is finally found, it doesn't seem to help much with the task at hand, but Uncle Podger treats it like a significant part of the process. His reaction to the missing coat is typical of his overreaction and inability to keep things organized, turning a simple task into a complicated and frustrating ordeal.

5. Write briefly on Uncle Podger's ability to delegate duty.

Ans: Uncle Podger is highly skilled at delegating duties, though it is not done in a productive or efficient manner. He sends different people in the house to fetch tools, search for lost items, and even hold things for him while he works. He delegates responsibility to others, but his instructions are often unclear, and he doesn't appreciate the help he receives. He treats everyone like they are at fault when something goes wrong and is quick to blame them for his own mistakes. His ability to delegate seems more like an excuse to avoid the work himself, as he expects others to do the legwork while he takes the credit for completing the task. This further adds to the chaos and confusion that surrounds him as he tries to hang the picture.

III. Answer the following questions in about two pages each.

1. Sketch the character of Uncle Podger.

Ans: Uncle Podger is a character whose behavior and personality are the focal points of humor in the story. He is depicted as an overconfident, clumsy, and well-meaning, yet completely disorganized man. Uncle Podger's pride in his own abilities is his most prominent trait. He believes that he is capable of handling tasks independently, even though he lacks the necessary skills and organization to do so effectively.

From the moment he decides to hang a picture on the wall, Uncle Podger's character traits are revealed. He insists that he doesn't need anyone's help, proclaiming that he can do the job himself. This confidence is exaggerated, as he fails at every step and makes the task unnecessarily complicated. His inability to carry out the simplest tasks without turning them into a disaster shows that his confidence is entirely misplaced.

Uncle Podger's tendency to delegate tasks to others is another key feature of his character. While he claims to be working hard, he sends everyone in the household on various errands to fetch tools, find the hammer, hold the ladder, or even bring his coat. Despite his requests, he is continually frustrated with the results, blaming others for things that go wrong, even though it is his own incompetence causing the issues.

Moreover, Uncle Podger's clumsiness adds to the comedy of his character. He loses the hammer, hits his thumb with it, misplaces his handkerchief, and even injures himself in the process. However, he does not take responsibility for his mistakes. Instead, he exaggerates his injuries, seeking sympathy while blaming everyone else for his own carelessness.

In summary, Uncle Podger is a comic figure defined by his overconfidence, lack of practical skill, and tendency to make simple tasks unnecessarily complicated. His actions and attitudes contribute to the humor in the story, as readers witness his failure to carry out even the most basic household task.

2. Examine the effect of Uncle Podger's behaviour on the rest of the family. How do they all react to him? What is the effect of their reactions on the reader?

Ans: Uncle Podger's behavior has a significant impact on the rest of the family, who find themselves caught in the web of his disorganized and chaotic attempt to hang a picture. Each family member reacts differently, but the overall effect of Uncle Podger's actions is one of frustration, exhaustion, and exasperation.

First and foremost, the family members are subjected to a series of commands and requests from Uncle Podger. He sends the children to fetch various tools, like the hammer, ladder, and ruler, and even asks them to hold the chair or ladder for him. The family members, although initially obedient, quickly realize that their help is not truly needed. Uncle Podger's blunders and incompetence make it clear that their assistance is merely a distraction to him. The more they try to help, the more the situation spirals out of control.

At several points in the story, Uncle Podger's frustration grows as he blames everyone but himself for his mistakes. When he injures himself by hitting his thumb with the hammer, he exaggerates the pain and complains loudly, demanding sympathy. He then shifts the blame onto the others, implying that they distracted him or caused the mishap.

This constant blame game makes the other family members feel even more resentful and weary.

Despite the tension created by Uncle Podger's actions, the family members do not react aggressively. Instead, they seem to retreat into passive obedience. They work to fetch the items he asks for, endure his shouting, and bear the frustration of his failures. This behavior from the family members mostly quiet compliance mixed with exasperation highlights their inability to challenge Uncle Podger's authority or to question his judgment.

The reactions of the family members create a sense of relatability for the reader, as many have likely encountered a person who complicates simple tasks and demands help without appreciating it. The family's exasperation is palpable, and readers are likely to sympathize with them. Their reactions highlight the humor in the story, as the more Uncle Podger insists on his competence, the more absurd and exaggerated the situation becomes.

The effect of the family's reactions on the reader is twofold: it amplifies the comedic aspect of the story, as we see the growing frustration of the family members, and it also evokes empathy for them. Readers are likely to identify with the family's helplessness and exhaustion, recognizing that they are being dragged into a situation entirely of Uncle Podger's making.

3. Would you call this a funny story? Substantiate your answer using suitable examples from the text.

Ans: Yes, "Uncle Podger Hangs a Picture" is undoubtedly a funny story. Jerome K. Jerome's use of exaggerated humor, absurd situations, and character flaws makes it a comical narrative that readers can laugh at and find amusing. The humor in the story arises from the clumsy actions of Uncle Podger, his misplaced confidence, and the way he causes chaos despite his best intentions.

One of the key sources of humor is Uncle Podger's belief that he can handle the task of hanging a picture without help. Right from the beginning, his arrogance is evident when he declares that he doesn't need anyone's assistance. However, as the story progresses, it becomes clear that his overconfidence is entirely misplaced. He sends family members on fruitless errands to fetch various tools, and in the process, he misplaces everything the hammer, the nail, and even his handkerchief. His constant

failure to find the right tools or even remember where he put them is humorous in its absurdity.

Another example of humor is Uncle Podger's clumsiness. When he hits his thumb with the hammer, he makes a huge fuss, exaggerating the pain and seeking sympathy from everyone around him. His overreaction to his small injury is comical, especially when he continues to blame others for the mishap. This behavior is amusing because of how out of proportion his reactions are to the actual events.

Additionally, the chaotic state of the house adds to the humor. The walls are scratched, furniture is displaced, and everyone is running around trying to fix the mess. The image of a room in disarray, all due to Uncle Podger's failed attempts, creates a funny visual. The absurdity of it all the fact that something as simple as hanging a picture has turned into such a disaster makes the reader laugh.

The story also includes a sense of irony. Uncle Podger, after making a complete mess of the task, concludes by saying that if a professional had been hired, it would have cost a lot of money and wouldn't have been done any better. This ironic statement is humorous because it highlights how delusional Uncle Podger is about his own abilities, despite the fact that he's made a huge mess of the situation.

Overall, the story's humor stems from Uncle Podger's lack of self-awareness, his misguided confidence, and the exaggerated chaos he causes. Through his clumsy actions and the reactions of his family members, Jerome K. Jerome creates a situation that is both ridiculous and highly amusing, making it an undeniably funny story.

My Lost Dollar - Stephen Leacock

A Note On The Author :

Stephen Leacock (1869-1944) is a Canadian writer of short stories and essays. He was a professor of English at McGill University, Montreal. The prose form is his forte, as he wrote about the stuff of everyday life with humour and psychological insight. His stories, first published in magazines in Canada and the United States and later in novel form, became extremely popular around the world.

My Lost Dollar Summary :

Introduction :

The story given below is an amusing one. The author informs the reader about a dollar that his friend has borrowed from him and apparently forgotten to pay back. Despite several instances where the money could have been returned, the friend refuses to acknowledge or return the same. This prompts the author to realise that he too, may have similarly borrowed a dollar from someone and forgotten to pay them back. He concludes by asking the concerned person to speak out and ask him for their money back.

Once, there was a man who found himself in a rather uncomfortable situation. It was all about a single dollar. A mere dollar, and yet it had become the source of a dilemma that he couldn't shake off.

It all started quite innocently. The man had lent a dollar to his friend some time ago, a simple enough thing. But as time passed, the dollar was never returned. And so, the dollar became a problem not because of the money itself, but because of the nagging feeling it left in the man's mind. It wasn't just the loss of the dollar that bothered him; it was the unspoken debt that had gone unresolved.

The man had tried to forget about it. It was only a dollar, after all. But as he went about his days, the thought of that dollar would resurface, nagging him. He would wonder: should he mention it? Should he just let it go? The dollar seemed so small in the grand scheme of things, yet it was weighing on him heavily.

Finally, the day came when he found himself face-to-face with his friend. His friend greeted him casually, unaware of the mental battle that had been raging in the man's mind for days. The man, who had been thinking about the dollar non-stop, now found himself in an awkward position. How could he bring it up? It felt wrong, even petty, to ask for such a small sum.

He hesitated. Should he just say it outright? Or should he act as if nothing had happened? His mind raced with possibilities, but he couldn't bring himself to say the words. His friend, on the other hand, remained blissfully unaware of the tension that had been building up.

As the conversation continued, the man tried to casually drop hints, but his friend simply carried on, uninterested in the mention of money. The man grew more and more uncomfortable. It wasn't just about the dollar anymore—it was about how to navigate this tricky situation without damaging the friendship.

Finally, after much internal debate, the man decided that he would have to say something. But just as he was about to speak, his friend suddenly said, "Oh! By the way, I meant to give you that dollar back. I almost forgot about it!"

The man's heart sank. His friend had completely forgotten. To him, it was no big deal just a small loan. But for the man, it had been an issue that had kept him awake at night, worrying about how to approach it, how to preserve the friendship while still getting his dollar back.

The whole situation seemed absurd to the man now. The dollar, which had seemed so important just moments before, was now trivial in his mind. It wasn't the money that mattered. It was the anxiety he had allowed himself to feel, all over something so small.

With the debt now settled, the man couldn't help but laugh at himself. He had built up this huge mental drama over a single dollar, when in reality, his friend hadn't even realized the debt existed. The whole thing had been an unnecessary complication in a perfectly simple friendship.

And so, the dollar was returned, but the lesson remained: sometimes, we let small things trivial things become much bigger than they really are. And often, the things we worry about the most are the ones that, in the end, don't matter at all.

Themes In the Story :

1. Money and Relationships: The story shows how something as small as a dollar can cause awkwardness and tension between friends, highlighting how money can complicate relationships.

2. Human Nature: It explores how people often overthink situations and avoid addressing uncomfortable issues, like the narrator's hesitation to ask for his dollar back.

3. Irony: The humor comes from the fact that the dollar, while important to the narrator, is not even noticed by the friend, demonstrating how trivial concerns can seem large in one's mind.

Conclusion:

The story reveals how small, insignificant matters (like a dollar) can become exaggerated in our minds. In the end, the dollar is returned, but the real lesson is about not letting trivial issues cause unnecessary stress in relationships.

I. Short Answer Questions.

1. Why does the speaker take his dollar, borrowed by his friend Todd, to be lost?

Ans: The speaker believes his dollar is lost because Todd has not returned it for a long time, and the speaker is unsure if Todd even remembers borrowing it. His obsession with the debt makes him think it's lost, even though Todd may have forgotten about it entirely.

2. Is Todd forgetful or unreliable?

Ans: Todd appears to be forgetful rather than unreliable. He simply forgets to repay the dollar and doesn't realize that the narrator still expects it to be returned. This suggests that Todd does not place much importance on the debt.

3. Is it possible for the narrator to forget the borrowed dollar? Why not?

Ans: No, it is not possible for the narrator to forget the borrowed dollar. The small debt occupies his mind because of his obsession with it, symbolizing how some people place undue importance on minor financial matters, especially when it involves trust.

4. If any man borrows a dollar from him, the narrator feels he will carry the debt of it to the grave.

Ans: This reflects the narrator's excessive attachment to the idea of repayment. He feels that if someone borrows money from him, he will always carry the burden of that loan, no matter how small the amount is. This demonstrates the narrator's tendency to overanalyze and internalize minor financial matters.

5. The narrator asked Todd what his trip cost him and then Todd said that he kept no

Ans: Records.

6. How would you describe this story in two words?

Ans: Humorous irony.

The story uses humor and irony to highlight the triviality of the situation, where the narrator makes a big deal out of a small financial matter.

II. Answer the following questions in about one pages each.

1. Why does the speaker/author suggest a taxi ride when he meets Todd at the train? Why does the speaker relate the circumstances of the borrowing with such accuracy?

Ans: The speaker suggests the taxi ride as a way to create a casual and friendly setting to meet Todd. However, it also highlights his discomfort and the unspoken tension about the borrowed dollar. The speaker relates the circumstances of the borrowing with great accuracy because it is something that has been weighing on his mind for a long time. He has been unable to forget the incident, even though it seems trivial to others. The precision in his recollection shows how much he values the debt and the act of lending, and how deeply it has affected him.

2. Give reasons for the speaker's desire to initiate a 'Back to Honesty' movement.

Ans: The speaker's desire to initiate a 'Back to Honesty' movement stems from his personal experiences with lending money and dealing with unpaid debts. He feels that the world would be better if people were more honest about their financial dealings, and perhaps the situation with Todd could be a model for others. The idea is that, by returning borrowed money, one could foster a more honest and transparent society. His own obsession with the borrowed dollar reflects his belief in the importance of honesty and responsibility in financial matters.

3. What does Todd write about in his letter from Bermuda?

Ans: In his letter from Bermuda, Todd writes about his vacation, sharing details of his trip in a carefree manner. Todd's letter is filled with casual observations and lacks any mention of repaying the borrowed dollar, further highlighting his indifference to the debt. He is wrapped up in the enjoyment of his holiday, without any concern for the minor debt he owes the narrator.

4. What contradiction does one find in Todd's attitude and behaviour?

Ans: The contradiction in Todd's behavior lies in his treatment of debts. While he has forgotten about the dollar he owes to the narrator, he is quick to criticize another person, Poland, for not paying back a debt. Todd's willingness to lecture others on financial responsibility, while neglecting his own small debt, shows a lack of self-awareness and inconsistency in his behavior.

5. Can Todd be accused of double standards since he takes Poland to task for not paying her debt while he has quietly forgotten to pay back the borrowed dollar?

Ans: Yes, Todd can be accused of double standards. He criticizes Poland for not repaying her debt but fails to recognize his own failure to repay the borrowed dollar. His hypocrisy is evident, as he is quick to judge others but does not hold himself to the same standards of accountability. This contradiction exposes Todd's lack of personal responsibility and his disregard for minor debts that don't seem important to him.

III. Answer the following questions in about two pages each.

1. The story is titled 'My Lost Dollar'. Why is this apt as opposed to "The Borrowed Dollar"?

Ans: The title "My Lost Dollar" is more apt than "The Borrowed Dollar" because it reflects the narrator's personal feelings towards the situation. The dollar is not just borrowed; in the narrator's mind, it is lost.

Although Todd only borrowed the dollar to pay for a taxi, he never returned it. Over time, the narrator begins to think of the dollar as something he will never get back. The word "lost" shows the emotional weight the narrator places on such a small amount. It also symbolizes how the narrator feels: he has lost not only the money but also a small piece of trust or expectation in his friendship with Todd.

If the story were called "The Borrowed Dollar," it would focus more on Todd's action. Instead, "My Lost Dollar" puts the focus on the narrator's feelings his obsession, disappointment, and exaggerated reaction to a minor event.

Thus, the title captures the narrator's personal sense of loss and his inability to move past a very trivial matter, which is the central theme and humour of the story.

2. Bring out the elements of humour in 'My Lost Dollar'.

Ans: "My Lost Dollar" is filled with humour, mainly through exaggeration, irony, and the narrator's overthinking. Here are some of the key elements:

Exaggeration: The narrator treats the loss of a single dollar as a major life event. His extreme seriousness about such a tiny debt is very funny. He even thinks about starting a "Back to Honesty" movement just because of one forgotten dollar!

Irony: It's ironic that the narrator can't forget the dollar, but Todd is completely unaware. Even funnier, Todd criticizes another person, Poland, for not repaying a debt while forgetting about the dollar he owes himself. This shows the double standards people have without even realizing it.

The Narrator's Obsession: The way the narrator describes keeping the memory of the dollar alive for a whole year adds to the humour. He even calculates how many days have passed since Todd borrowed it, and every time he sees Todd, he hopes for repayment without saying anything.

Understatement: When Todd writes casually from Bermuda without mentioning the dollar, the narrator's quiet frustration is funny. The narrator never confronts Todd but builds up a huge story in his head instead.

Sarcasm and Satire: The story also gently mocks human nature especially how we can make mountains out of molehills and hold silent grudges over silly things.

Overall, the humour comes from the mismatch between the trivial event and the narrator's serious emotional response.

3. How important do you think honesty and keeping promises, even for small amounts of money, is in maintaining friendships?

Ans: Honesty and keeping promises, even for small amounts like a dollar, are very important in maintaining friendships. Trust is the foundation of any relationship, and money, no matter how little, can test that trust.

In "My Lost Dollar", the narrator feels uncomfortable not because he is financially hurt by the missing dollar, but because Todd's failure to return it shows a lack of attention or respect. It leaves a small crack in their friendship. Even though Todd probably forgot unintentionally, the narrator sees it as a broken promise.

When friends repay even small debts or keep their promises, it shows that they value the relationship and the other person's feelings. Small actions show big character. Neglecting small things like a borrowed dollar can make friends feel unimportant or taken for granted.

Moreover, failing to repay small loans or fulfill small promises can build up resentment over time, just like in the story where the narrator's frustration grows silently. Good friendships survive on clear communication and mutual respect. Honesty, even in little matters, prevents misunderstandings and helps maintain strong, healthy bonds.

Thus, honesty and keeping promises, even for small things, are essential to maintaining the trust and respect that true friendship needs.

The Sporting Spirit - George Orwell

A Note On the Author :

George Orwell (1903-1950) was the pen name of Eric Arthur Blair. He was born in Motihari, India. His father, Richard Walmesley Blair was a civil servant for the British government. As he failed to win a university scholarship in England and without an opportunity to continue his education, he went to Burma and served in the administration of the Indian Imperial Police from 1922 to 1927. Later he went back to England and decided to become a professional writer. His world renowned novels are Animal Farm and 1984.

The Sporting Spirit Summary :

Introduction :

George Orwell, in his essay "The Sporting Spirit," attacks the romantic notion that sports promote international understanding, peace, and friendship. He takes a strong stand against the idea that sporting competitions can reduce conflicts between nations. Orwell believes that in the modern world, especially after the rise of nationalism and mass media, sports have become another weapon for promoting hatred and rivalry among different groups of people.

Main Argument: Sports Cause Hatred, Not Friendship

Orwell starts by pointing out that whenever two countries meet in a sporting competition, it often leads to an increase in national hostility instead of goodwill. Whether it's football, boxing, or any other competitive sport, the desire to win leads players and spectators to develop negative feelings towards the opponents. Instead of shaking hands and feeling friendly, people often walk away from matches angry, resentful, and even more divided.

He uses real-life examples to prove his point. One major example he mentions is the 1945 tour of a Soviet football team (Dynamo Moscow) in Britain. Instead of improving relations between Britain and the Soviet Union after World War II, the matches were full of controversies, accusations of cheating, unfair refereeing, and public outrage. Instead of creating a spirit of brotherhood, the competition created bitterness and tension.

The Nature of Modern Sports:

Orwell emphasizes that modern sports have changed drastically from their original purpose. In ancient times, games were played for recreation, physical fitness, or fun. Today, however, sports are professional, commercial, and heavily political.

Players are trained like machines: They are pushed to their physical and mental limits, not for personal enjoyment, but for the glory of the nation.

Winning at all costs: The focus is no longer on "playing the game" but solely on winning and defeating the opponent.

Spectators' emotions: The public views these games as serious battles. They emotionally attach their national pride to the success or failure of the team.

This professionalization and commercialization of sports, Orwell argues, have made games less about enjoyment and more about warfare without weapons.

The Role of Nationalism:

One of the key points Orwell makes is that nationalism and sports are deeply connected. In international competitions, athletes represent not themselves, but their country. As a result, victory becomes a symbol of a nation's superiority, while defeat is taken personally as a national insult.

Instead of building bridges between cultures, sports become a platform for people to boast, insult, and humiliate each other on an international stage.

Mass media — newspapers, radio, and later television — also fuels this nationalism by exaggerating small incidents, glorifying victories, and blaming defeats on unfairness or cheating by the other side.

Examples and Evidence:

Orwell supports his argument with examples from different countries:

The tensions between Britain and the Soviet Union after the 1945 football matches.

The rivalry and hatred seen during matches between India and Britain.

The fierce competitions between different countries during the Olympic Games, which often mirror political tensions.

In all these cases, Orwell shows how sports do not help in bringing people together. Instead, they reflect and even worsen the political and social divisions that already exist.

Conclusion:

Orwell concludes that the idea of sports promoting peace is a myth. In reality, modern sports have become a continuation of political conflict by other means. Sportsmanship is often talked about, but rarely practiced when the stakes are high. Therefore, Orwell suggests that sports, far from promoting harmony, mostly intensify hatred, aggression, and division among people and nations.

I. Short Answer Questions.

1. What example does the essay open with?

Ans: The essay opens with the example of the visit of the Russian football team, Dynamo Moscow, to Britain in 1945, which resulted in increased hostility and bitterness between the British and the Russians instead of promoting goodwill.

2. Which is the worst sport according to the author?

Ans: According to George Orwell, boxing is the worst sport because it involves direct physical violence and often stirs up the worst feelings of hatred between opponents.

3. Mention the sport described as a 'leisurely game' by the author.

Ans: Orwell describes cricket as a leisurely game, highlighting that it was once played more for enjoyment and relaxation rather than for fierce competition.

4. The writer wishes to send only a second-rate British team to the USSR as a follow-up to the Dynamos' visit because:

- a. he wants them to lose, preventing more aggression in the name of sports.
- b. he is sure England doesn't need a first-rate team to beat the USSR football team.
- c. he couldn't care less about sports.
- d. he would rather they win the Olympic finals than a match against the USSR.

Ans: a. he wants them to lose, preventing more aggression in the name of sports.

5. Why does country living have no time for sports?

- a. because there is too much work to be done
- b. children are not allowed to play
- c. there is no place for sports
- d. there are many outdoor activities that give young people outlets to expend energy

Ans: a. because there is too much work to be done.

6. is considered to be the founder of the modern public school.

Ans: Thomas Arnold is considered to be the founder of the modern public school.

II. Answer the following questions in about one page each.

1. Why does the writer consider that sports played at international level can only be a 'mimic warfare'?

Ans: The writer considers international sports to be a form of 'mimic warfare' because they create the same emotions and rivalries as real wars. Instead of promoting

friendship, international sporting events stir up nationalistic feelings, where each side tries to prove its superiority over the other. Orwell points out that when countries meet in the field of sports, it often leads to bad tempers, cheating, and hatred, similar to the emotions involved in actual battles. Thus, international sports are like a substitute for war, where the battlefield is replaced by the sports field, but the underlying aggression remains the same.

2. What makes the writer conclude that 'serious sport has nothing to do with fair play'?

Ans: The writer concludes that 'serious sport has nothing to do with fair play' because, in highly competitive matches, the only goal is to win at any cost. Players and fans become so obsessed with victory that they are willing to cheat, use foul methods, and behave aggressively. Orwell notes that serious sport is about boastfulness, rivalry, hatred, and physical violence, all of which go against the idea of fair play. Thus, the true spirit of sportsmanship is lost when sports are played seriously on a professional level.

3. Explore why the writer regards urban communities as primarily responsible for the flourishing of organised games?

Ans: Orwell believes that urban communities are responsible for the flourishing of organized games because city life lacks natural physical activities that are common in rural areas. In the countryside, people are occupied with farming, hunting, fishing, and other outdoor work, which keeps them physically active. However, in cities, people lead more sedentary lives and need artificial ways to maintain physical fitness. As a result, organized sports were introduced and popularized in urban areas to provide a structured form of physical activity and entertainment. Urbanization thus created the need for sports clubs, leagues, and competitive games.

4. What, according to the writer, is the cause for the rise of the modern cult of sport? How does it differ from the past?

Ans: According to Orwell, the rise of the modern cult of sport is mainly due to nationalism and mass commercialism. In the past, sports were leisurely activities played for enjoyment and fitness. There was little concern about victory or defeat. However, in modern times, sports have become a symbol of national pride and international prestige. Winning has become essential, and sports have turned into a serious business where emotions, politics, and national interests are deeply involved. The casual spirit of games from the past has been replaced by aggressive competition and professionalism.

5. Annotate the following:

"I am always amazed when I hear people saying that sport created goodwill between the nations, and that if only the common peoples of the world could

meet one another at football or cricket, they would have no inclination to meet on battlefield."

Ans: In this line, Orwell expresses his disbelief at the common claim that sports foster international goodwill. He argues that, contrary to popular belief, sports often create more bitterness, rivalry, and hatred among nations. The statement is ironic because Orwell has observed that sporting competitions, far from preventing wars, actually promote nationalistic feelings similar to those that cause wars. Instead of reducing aggression, sports often serve as a trigger for it.

III. Answer the following questions in about two pages each.

1. How does the writer relate sporting spirit to nationalism?

Ans: In *The Sporting Spirit*, George Orwell strongly argues that modern sports are deeply tied to nationalism. He believes that sports, especially when played at an international level, are no longer just about enjoyment or physical exercise. Instead, they have become a way for countries to prove their superiority over others. According to Orwell, whenever two countries meet on the sports field, the game becomes a symbolic war where each side wants to dominate the other.

Orwell explains that the emotions seen in serious sports such as pride, anger, and hostility are very similar to those seen in actual warfare. Winning a match is seen as a national victory, and losing one can feel like a national insult. This creates tension not only among players but also among spectators, who cheer aggressively for their own country and jeer at the opponent. Orwell says that such emotions do not create goodwill but rather encourage hatred between nations.

He gives the example of the Russian football team, Dynamo Moscow's visit to Britain. Instead of promoting friendly relations, it led to arguments, accusations of unfairness, and bitterness. Orwell points out that this is not an isolated case similar things happen wherever sports and nationalism mix. Whether it is football, cricket, or boxing, national pride becomes more important than fair play.

Thus, Orwell clearly relates sporting spirit to nationalism by showing that sports have become an extension of political and national rivalry. Instead of building friendship between nations, sports often deepen their divisions.

2. List out the sports/games mentioned by the author in this essay and outline his opinion about them.

Ans: In *The Sporting Spirit*, Orwell mentions several sports and expresses his critical opinions about them. The main sports he discusses are:

Football (Soccer): Orwell discusses football a lot because it is one of the most emotional and aggressive sports internationally. He says that football matches between nations stir up bad feelings and violent behavior among spectators. It becomes a way to show national strength rather than friendly competition.

Cricket: Orwell describes cricket as a leisurely game in its earlier days. He acknowledges that cricket was once played in a relaxed manner without much focus on winning. However, he also notes that even cricket has become more competitive and serious, losing its original charm.

Boxing: Boxing is called the worst sport by Orwell. He criticizes it harshly because it involves direct physical violence. Two men are encouraged to hurt each other for public entertainment, and it brings out the worst feelings of anger and hatred.

Rugby: Rugby is mentioned as another highly competitive sport. Like football, it often leads to strong, aggressive emotions among players and fans. Orwell believes that such sports encourage physical violence and nationalistic pride.

Baseball: Although Orwell briefly mentions baseball, he mainly talks about how it is popular in America. He implies that, like other organized games, it is a product of urban society needing structured physical activities.

Hunting, Fishing, Hiking (Country pursuits): Orwell contrasts organized games with natural country activities like hunting, fishing, and hiking. He views these activities positively because they are done individually or in small groups and do not lead to the aggressive competitiveness seen in modern sports.

In summary: Orwell sees most organized sports as harmful because they encourage nationalism, aggression, and hatred. He prefers the simpler, less competitive activities of rural life, which he thinks are healthier for individuals and society.

3. Do you subscribe to Orwell's views on the sporting spirit? Justify your standpoint.

Ans: My view partly agrees with George Orwell's ideas about the sporting spirit. Orwell is right in saying that sports can promote nationalism and rivalry. Even today, when

countries play against each other in events like the FIFA World Cup, the Olympics, or cricket matches, fans can become extremely emotional. Fights among spectators, harsh comments on social media, and cheating scandals show that sometimes, sports do bring out the worst feelings in people.

However, I also believe that Orwell's view is a little too negative. Sports have many positive sides that he does not fully acknowledge. Sports can bring people from different countries together, give them a chance to respect each other's talents, and learn about different cultures. Events like the Olympics aim to promote peace and unity among nations, even though rivalry exists.

Moreover, for individual players and fans, sports can teach valuable lessons like teamwork, discipline, hard work, and resilience. Even though some people may take competition too far, most sports still carry the spirit of fair play and friendship. A good example is when players from opposing teams help each other up after a fall or show respect by shaking hands after a tough match.

In conclusion, I partly agree with Orwell that sports can cause aggression and nationalistic pride. However, I believe that when played with the right spirit, sports can also be a powerful force for friendship, peace, and personal growth. The key lies in maintaining a balance celebrating victories with humility and accepting defeats gracefully.

Sir M. Visvesvaraya

About Sir M. Visvesvaraya :

Sir M. Visvesvaraya was a renowned Indian engineer and statesman, born on September 15, 1861, in Muddenahalli, Karnataka. He is best known for his role as the Diwan of Mysore, where he contributed to the construction of the Krishnarajasagara Dam and the development of flood protection systems. His invention of the automatic sluice gate greatly improved water management in India.

Visvesvaraya was also a strong advocate for education, helping to establish institutions like the Government Engineering College in Bangalore. He was knighted by the British in 1915 and awarded the Bharat Ratna in 1955. His legacy is honored on Engineers' Day, celebrated annually on September 15.

Biography of Sir M. Visvesvaraya Summary :

Did you know that in India, we actually have a special day just to celebrate engineers? It's called Engineers' Day, and it's on September 15. We celebrate it to honour Mokshagundam Visvesvaraya or Sir MV as most people call him. He wasn't just any engineer. He was one of India's first civil engineers and made a huge difference by making dams and rivers safer. He was also a brilliant administrator and a big supporter of education. In fact, he was awarded the Bharat Ratna India's highest civilian award in 1955.

Sir MV was born way back on 15 September 1861, in a small village called Muddenahalli in Karnataka. After schooling at the Wesleyan Mission High School in Bangalore, he went to Central College and got a Bachelor's degree in Science. Then he studied engineering at the College of Science in Pune, where he topped both his engineering exams the LCE and the FCE in 1883.

Once he finished his studies, he started working for the British government in what was then the Bombay Presidency. He worked as an assistant engineer in places like Pune, Khandesh, and Nasik. His real passion was irrigation and flood control. In 1899, he joined the Indian Irrigation Commission. His work was so impressive that his designs

were used not just in India but even in other British colonies like Yemen, Tanzania, and Sri Lanka they even celebrate Engineers' Day for him there!

One of his coolest innovations came in 1893. In Sindh (now in Pakistan), the town of Sukkur had a big problem: the only water source was the dirty Indus River. Sir MV invented a smart system called collector wells natural water filters dug into the riverbed which gave the town clean drinking water.

He also introduced the block system of irrigation in the Deccan region, allowing water to reach more villages using a series of canals. And in 1915, he designed automatic floodgates to control water levels and prevent flooding, first installed at Khadakwasla Dam and later at Tigra Dam and Krishnaraja Sagar Dam one of his most famous projects. And you know what's amazing? Even though he patented this design, he refused to accept any royalty for it.

In 1906-07, he was sent to Aden (now in Yemen) to build their water and drainage systems.

But in 1905, he voluntarily retired from the British civil service and went on a world tour to study the best irrigation systems. Soon after, the Musi River flooded Hyderabad terribly in 1908, killing around 15,000 people. The Nizam of Hyderabad asked Sir MV for help. Using data and smart planning, Sir MV suggested building two huge reservoirs Himayatsagar and Osmansagar which saved the city from future floods. He also rebuilt river banks and turned flood-prone residential areas into parks.

While still working on Hyderabad's floods, he was invited to become Chief Engineer of Mysore. But before accepting, he made sure the Mysore government was serious about encouraging industries and education. Once assured, he joined in 1909, and immediately started work on the Krishnaraja Sagar Dam. His plan was inspired by the famous Tennessee Valley project in the US not just flood control but also power generation to drive industries.

In 1912, Sir MV was promoted to Dewan of Mysore. For six years, until 1918, he led the state into massive industrialisation: founding the Mysore Iron and Steel Works (later named after him), Mysore Sugar Factory, Karnataka Soaps and Detergents Ltd (makers of the famous Mysore Sandal Soap), and the Government Sandalwood Oil Factory.

He deeply believed in education, especially technical education. When he became Dewan, Mysore had only around 4,500 schools. By the time he left, it had 11,000! He

pushed hard for girls' education too. And thanks to his efforts, the University of Mysore was set up in 1916.

Earlier in 1915, he had already founded an agricultural school in Hebbal, which is today the University of Agricultural Sciences in Bangalore. He also helped start the Mechanical Engineering School, the School of Commerce at Mysore, and the famous University Visvesvaraya College of Engineering (UVCE) in Bangalore. He was so influential that he became the first president of the Indian Institute of Science Court from 1935 to 1946.

Even after retiring as Dewan in 1918, Sir MV continued advising governments and leaders. He was a strong supporter of a planned economy — way before it became popular in India. He wrote a book called Planned Economy for India and even pushed for projects the British thought were crazy — like setting up an aircraft factory near Bangalore, which later became Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL).

Because of all this amazing work, Sir MV received tons of awards. He was knighted in 1915, got the Kaiser-i-Hind medal for his work in Aden, was made an Honorary Life Member of the Institution of Civil Engineers in London, and received eight honorary doctorates.

He lived an incredible, long life 102 years and passed away on April 14, 1962. And here's a fun fact: Sir MV even designed Jayanagar in South Bangalore it was one of Asia's largest and most planned housing colonies at the time!

I. Short Answer Questions.

1. As Chief Engineer in the erstwhile state of Mysore, what were two of his major contributions to the state?

Ans: As Chief Engineer in Mysore, Sir M. Visvesvaraya's two major contributions were the design and supervision of the Krishna Raja Sagara (KRS) Dam and the promotion of industrialization, particularly through the establishment of the Mysore Iron and Steel Works.

2. What is the block system of irrigation and what was Sir M. Visvesvaraya's contribution to it?

Ans: The block system of irrigation involves dividing the land into blocks and providing water to each block based on a set schedule. Sir M. Visvesvaraya introduced this system in the dry Deccan region, ensuring that water was distributed efficiently across large areas to improve agriculture.

3. Which of the following were not set up by Sir MV?

- a. Mysore University
- b. University of Agricultural Science
- c. University Visvesvaraya College of Engineering
- d. National Law Institute

Ans: d. National Law Institute

4. Sir MV retired as Dewan of Mysore in:

- a. 1920
- b. 1918
- c. 1940
- d. 1909

Ans: b. 1918

5. Why did Sir MV push for the establishment of an aeronautics manufacturing facility in Bangalore?

Ans: Sir MV pushed for the establishment of an aeronautics manufacturing facility in Bangalore to boost industrialization in India and support the country's defense capabilities. His foresight led to the creation of Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd, which became a leader in India's aviation industry.

6. What was Sir MV's contribution to housing colony planning?

Ans: Sir MV designed and planned the layout for one of the first planned neighborhoods in Bangalore, named Layanagar, which was Asia's largest housing colony at the time. His approach emphasized organized and efficient urban planning.

II. Answer the following questions in about one page each.

1. Highlight some of Sir M Visvesvaraya's contributions as public works engineer in the Bombay Presidency.

Ans: Sir M. Visvesvaraya made numerous contributions as a public works engineer in the Bombay Presidency. His work focused on irrigation, flood control, and water supply. Notably, he designed and implemented an advanced water filtration system in Sukkur, Sind (now in Pakistan), where he introduced the concept of "collector wells," which provided clean, potable water from the muddy Indus River. His engineering innovations were instrumental in improving the region's infrastructure, especially in the face of flooding and water scarcity.

2. As Dewan of Mysore, what were Sir M. Visvesvaraya's contributions to the upliftment of education?

Ans: As Dewan of Mysore, Sir M. Visvesvaraya made significant strides in the development of education. He recognized the importance of technical education and played a key role in establishing institutions like the University of Mysore (1916) and the University of Agricultural Sciences in Hebbal. His vision extended to engineering and commerce, leading to the foundation of the Government Engineering College (later named University Visvesvaraya College of Engineering) in Bangalore. His efforts expanded educational opportunities for all sections of society, especially for the underprivileged.

3. Write a short note on how Sir MV helped the Nizam of Hyderabad deal with flooding in the city of Hyderabad.

Ans: In 1908, the city of Hyderabad was devastated by severe flooding from the river Musi, resulting in significant loss of life. Sir M. Visvesvaraya was called upon to help prevent future disasters. He analyzed rainfall patterns, river catchment areas, and settlement data, recommending the construction of two large reservoirs: Himayatsagar and Osmansagar. His flood control measures included raising and lining the riverbanks with stone and cement, while converting flood-prone areas into parks as buffer zones. These measures saved Hyderabad from similar disasters in the future.

4. Write a short note on Sir MV's contributions to water filtration systems.

Ans: Sir M. Visvesvaraya's contributions to water filtration were revolutionary. In 1893, he designed the "collector well" system while working in Sukkur, Sind (now in Pakistan), to address the issue of muddy water from the Indus River. The system involved digging wells in the riverbed near the bank to tap into naturally filtered water. This clean water was then piped to the town for consumption. This innovation in water filtration greatly improved public health and was a significant step in ensuring access to potable water in arid regions.

III. Answer the Following Questions in About two Pages Each.

1. Sir M. Visvesvaraya was a person of foresight and vision. How does the essay substantiate this?

Ans: The essay highlights Sir M. Visvesvaraya's exceptional foresight and vision in multiple instances. His ability to foresee the long-term benefits of various engineering and administrative projects is evident in his contributions to water management, industrialization, and education. For instance, his visionary role in the construction of the Krishna Raja Sagara (KRS) Dam in Mysore not only aimed at flood control but also at harnessing water for power generation, which helped industrialize the region. This was a forward-thinking project that considered both agricultural and industrial development.

Furthermore, Visvesvaraya's idea of creating a planned economy, as outlined in his book "Planned Economy in India," showcased his deep understanding of the importance of strategic development in the country. His recommendation for establishing an aircraft manufacturing facility in Bangalore, which eventually led to the creation of Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd, shows his ability to think beyond the immediate needs and envision a future of industrial strength for India. This reflects his foresight and vision in promoting long-term growth and progress for India.

2. "The effective utilization of water resources was his passion." How was this borne out in Sir M. Visvesvaraya's life? Do you agree with this statement? Why or why not?

Ans: The statement "The effective utilization of water resources was his passion" is substantiated in several instances throughout Sir M. Visvesvaraya's life, particularly in his work on irrigation, flood control, and water filtration systems. He was deeply committed to solving water-related challenges and improving the lives of communities through better water management. His development of the block system of irrigation, especially in the dry Deccan region, helped ensure that water was distributed efficiently

to support agricultural production in various villages. This initiative highlighted his passion for utilizing water resources effectively.

Moreover, Sir MV's creation of the innovative 'collector well' system for filtering water in Sukkur, Sind (now in Pakistan) exemplifies his ingenuity in ensuring the availability of clean water. He identified the importance of clean water for public health and took proactive steps to address water pollution in arid regions.

I fully agree with this statement. Sir M. Visvesvaraya's consistent focus on improving water management throughout his career whether in designing floodgates to control floods, his work on the Krishna Raja Sagara Dam, or his efforts in establishing sustainable irrigation systems demonstrates his enduring passion for effectively utilizing water resources.

3. Elucidate your impressions of Sir M. Visvesvaraya. How would you evaluate his work and achievements?

Ans: Sir M. Visvesvaraya was a man of exceptional intellect, dedication, and vision. His work spanned multiple domains, from engineering to education, and his achievements have left a lasting impact on modern India. As an engineer, his contributions to irrigation, flood control, and water management were pioneering. His work on the Krishna Raja Sagara Dam, his development of the block irrigation system, and his innovation in water filtration systems in Sukkur were all groundbreaking. He demonstrated an impressive ability to address the practical needs of society through engineering solutions.

Beyond engineering, Sir MV's vision for industrial and educational development was remarkable. As Dewan of Mysore, he pushed for the establishment of several educational institutions, including Mysore University and the University of Agricultural Sciences. He also recognized the importance of industrialization and played a crucial role in setting up industries that would contribute to the state's economy, such as the Mysore Iron and Steel Works.

His role as a visionary administrator is also evident in his work on flood control in Hyderabad, where his planning saved the city from future disasters. He also advocated for a planned economy, which was an advanced concept for his time, and he pushed for the establishment of modern industries like Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd.

Overall, Sir M. Visvesvaraya's achievements demonstrate an extraordinary ability to think ahead and address the challenges faced by society with innovative solutions. His work in engineering, education, and industrial development is a testament to his far-reaching impact on India's progress.

4. Does Sir M. Visvesvaraya seem like a person whose example you would like to follow? Validate your answer with instances from the text.

Ans: Yes, Sir M. Visvesvaraya is undoubtedly a person whose example I would like to follow. His life was one of relentless dedication to his work, his country, and the betterment of society. One of the qualities that stands out is his foresight in planning for long-term benefits, such as his work on the Krishna Raja Sagara Dam, which not only addressed flood control but also provided power generation to support industrial growth. This vision for holistic development is something I deeply admire.

Another trait that makes Sir MV an admirable figure is his commitment to education. His efforts in expanding education in Mysore, particularly the establishment of universities and institutions like Mysore University and the University of Agricultural Sciences, show his belief in the power of knowledge as a tool for social progress. I believe this emphasis on education is a vital principle that can continue to shape positive futures.

Moreover, his passion for the effective use of resources, particularly water, is something that resonates with the current need for sustainable solutions to environmental challenges. His innovative approach to solving water-related problems, such as the 'collector well' system and his work in Hyderabad, is a clear example of how a person can make a meaningful impact on public welfare.

Overall, Sir M. Visvesvaraya's blend of technical expertise, visionary thinking, and commitment to societal development makes him a role model. His work serves as an inspiration for anyone seeking to make a positive, lasting contribution to society.